The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Wrathful One Acala

Āryācalanāmadhāraṇī · Toh 963 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཁྲོ་བོ་མི་གཡོ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Wrathful One Acala, known in Sanskrit as the Āryācala-nāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as ’phags pa khro bo mi g.yo ba, is a short dhāraṇī text centered on Acala, the "Immovable One," a fierce protective deity. After paying homage to the Three Jewels, it vividly describes Acala's form. He has the body of a man in the prime of youth and is dark as summer rain clouds. He blazes like the fire at the end of an eon, stands in a wrestler's stance, and has red eyes, bared fangs, and a frowning brow. Above all, he is presented as the destroyer of all malevolent forces, such as māras and nāgas. The text belongs to the class of dhāraṇī literature, which preserves potent formulas and invocations used for protection and the removal of obstacles. It is Toh 963 in the Kangyur, where it appears among the collected dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: ārya acala nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Wrathful One Acala.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

The great wrathful one Acala destroys all the malevolent ones, such as māras and nāgas. His bodily form is like that of a man who has reached the prime of youth. His color is like the rain clouds of summer. Like the fire at the end of an eon, he fills the sky with light. He is supremely majestic, like a wish-fulfilling tree. His legs, one stretched out and one drawn in, are like the stride of a champion wrestler. His eyes are red like the flowers of the palāśa tree. His fangs are bared like the crescent moon. His darting tongue is like the lightning of a thunderbolt. His brows are knit in a wrathful frown like the leaves of the bhiśa tree. In his right hand he holds a sword, like the arrow of a planet. In his left he holds a lasso, like the serpent at the neck of the ocean.

The blue Nanda and Upananda form his headband. The variegated yellow Padma and Mahāpadma form his earrings. The white Śaṅkhapāla forms his necklace. The green Kulika forms his long garland. The black Ananta and Takṣaka form his anklets.

By uttering ha hi hūṃ he terrifies Brahmā, Viṣṇu, Īśvara (Śiva), the nāgas, the yakṣas, the piśācas, and all the bhūtas. By uttering haṃ maṃ he makes them faint. He averts diseases and epidemics, grahas and enemies, weapons and

robbers, wild beasts and quarrels, bad dreams and evil omens. He spoke the secret mantra which, recited but once, destroys gods, nāgas, and bhūtas:

namaḥ smanta āryacalanaṃ traṭa traṭa amogha caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa sphoṭaya sphoṭaya hūṃ tramaya tramaya hūṃ phaṭ trvathaḥ haṃ maṃ tadyathā oṃ āḥ hūṃ śuddhe śuddhe raṃ hoya biśuddhe biśuddhe aśumaṃ biśuraṃ śodhane biśodhane caṇḍa caṇḍa mama bala bala mara mara maraya maraya sarba śatruṃ sarba bighnana sarba duṣṭaṃ hūṃ phaṭ oṃ caṇḍa mahāroṣaṇa hūṃ phaṭ

As for its rite: place the syllables haṃ maṃ upon whatever substance it may be. If one empowers it with this mantra one hundred and eight times, whatever one sets out to accomplish will be accomplished.

With a sword made of the five kinds of metal one turns back all the armies of others.

With musk, aconite, asafoetida, and a crow's beak, every kind of graha whatsoever can be overcome.

If one bathes with a vase filled with water, all diseases are cured.

If one places gold, silver, coral, pearl, and crystal in a jeweled vessel and makes supplication, one will obtain wealth.

Musk, mālā, and white garlic protect against all diseases.

If one mixes nutmeg, saffron, cloves, cardamom, bamboo manna, kakkola, musk, and camphor in a clean casket and anoints the eyes with it, one will see the bhūtas.

If one brandishes a vulture's talon and a tiger's fang toward the direction in which a hailstorm is moving, it will be turned back.

If one makes the figure of a nāga from monkey fat and worships it without interruption, it will make the rain fall.

If one binds a mantra yantra to a ritual peg of śirīṣa wood and fixes it securely, enemies and thieves will be turned back.

If one meditates with focus on the rays of the light of wisdom, all wrongdoing and obscurations will be purified.

If sons or daughters of noble family, endowed with compassion, take this as their sacred commitment and read it, recite it, and repeat it, they will without doubt attain accomplishment.

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Wrathful One Acala is complete.

Translated by the paṇḍita Dharmatāśīla and the translator, the monk Chökyi Zangpo.

Translator's Notes

• Several images and ritual details are obscure. The "bhiśa tree" is left as written and is unidentified. "The serpent at the neck of the ocean" is a literal rendering of an unclear simile. The material from which the nāga figure is made is read as "monkey fat," which is uncertain. The phrase rendered "without interruption" is unclear in the Tibetan and is a tentative reading. "Fixes it securely" is a tentative rendering of an unclear verb. The ingredient "mālā" is unidentified and is left as written. The wood of the peg is taken to be śirīṣa.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.